[METRIC]
A-A-417C
July 08, 1998
SUPERSEDING
A-A-417B
April 5, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
RIBBON, TYPEWRITER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. **Scope:** This Commercial Item Description covers nylon fabric ribbons to be used on typewriters.

2. **Salient Characteristics:**

2.1 **Weave.** The fabric shall have a regular commercial weave suitable for the purpose intended. Ribbon edges shall be straight and paralleled to the warp threads. To prevent fraying, edges of ribbons shall be fused.

2.2 **Ribbons.** The ribbons shall be of the dimensions established by the machine manufacturer for proper operations and the contractor shall certify that the ribbons are made to the original manufacturers specifications. The ribbons shall be firmly, evenly, and uniformly wound in cartridges, or on spools or cores designed for proper operation with the machines specified (see note).

2.3 **Thickness & Yarn Count.** Ribbon thickness and yarn count shall be as specified in table I. in accordance with ASTM D 1777 to determine thickness. Edges shall not be used to determine fabric thickness.

2.4 **Color.** Ribbons shall be single color or two color as specified. Two-color ribbons shall have an equal width for each color, unless otherwise specified.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7510

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Table I.
Ribbon Thickness Chart

Thickness (Inches)	Total Yarn Count (min) Threads Per. Sq. Inch	Warp Minimum Threads Per. Sq. Inch	Fill Minimum Threads Per. Sq. Inch
0.0038 - 0.0042 inch	277 - 296	165	112
0.0030 - 0.0036 inch	287 - 302	176	111

2.8 Spools, Cartridges, & Cores. Each ribbon shall be furnished on a metal or plastic spool, cartridge, fiber core, fiber center or in a coreless configuration for the specified machine. Metal, except aluminum, shall have an enamel, lacquer, or plated finish. Each ribbon shall be designed to operate satisfactorily with the ribbon feed and reversing mechanisms of the machine specified.

2.9 Workmanship. Ribbons shall be evenly woven and free from imperfections of manufacture that may effect their durability, appearance or serviceability. Examples of ribbon defects are uneven weave, frayed edges, slits, and knots. The ribbon spools, cartridges or cores shall be free from all defects that will affect performance and serviceability or present a hazard to the user.

2.10 Shelf Life. Ribbons shall have a shelf life of one year after delivery and shall be capable of withstanding normal usage and handling and pass the performance test in accordance with paragraph 4.2.

3. Regulatory Requirements: The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practical, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

3.1 Hazardous Material Requirements.

3.1.1 Toxicity. Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the ribbon conforms to the above requirements.

3.1.2 Material Safety Data Sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

3.1.3 Labeling. Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

4. Quality Assurance Provisions:

4.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description. The quality of the product sold to the government shall be equal to or better than the quality of the product sold by the manufacturer in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

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4.2 Performance Test.

4.2.1 Select one sample ribbon and place in the machine designated for its use in the contract and operate the machine in the normal manner until the ribbon has run its full course and is wound from one side to the other. During the course of the test operation, the ribbon shall be observed to ensure that it is not binding or twisting so as to interfere with proper printing. Upon completion of the test, the printing matter (the product of the ribbon printing test), shall be examined to ensure that the quality of print is uniformly dark and with no blank spots, light spots, or discontinuities. Failure to comply with any of these requirements shall be cause for rejection after testing in accordance with ASTM F 92.

4.2.2 As an alternative to the prescribed performance test, the contractor may supply a certification from the equipment manufacturer that the ribbon, identified by part number has been tested and will function properly on the equipment for which it was designed. Selected samples will then be tested on any compatible printer for the print quality defined above.

4.2.3 If the equipment manufacturer refuses to certify the ribbon or tape, then the ribbon manufacturer may then certify that the ribbon manufacturer (contractor) guarantees that the ribbon or tape will function properly on the equipment for which it has been designed.

4.2.4 Ribbon Condition (end of test). Ribbon shall withstand the test without signs of excessive frayed edges, excessive curling, or the development of holes. Excessive shall be interpreted to mean when frayed edges or curling (1) is the cause of broken characters or (2) interfere with proper ribbon feed.

Table II.
Impression/Character Yield of Printer Ribbons

	Test Hours	Percent Reflectance (not more than)
Single - color, black	5	40
Two - color, black and red:		
Black Portion	4	45
Red Portion	3	65

5. Packaging:

5.1 Packaging, packing, palletization and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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6. **Notes:**

6.1 **Source of Documents.** The following documents form a part of the commercial item description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

6.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.1.2 Copies of the appropriate ASTM's may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials at 100 Barr Harbor Dr., West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

6.1.3 Federal Standards and Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington DC 20407.

6.2 **Ordering information.** Purchasers shall select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
(2) Purchaser shall specify the ribbon dimensions and shall indicate length, width, color and inking criteria (if other than specified in the CID), manufacturer's name and model number of the machine on which the ribbon will be used in the procurement document. Purchasers shall indicate the original manufacturers specifications (OEM) if required.
(3) Material safety data sheets required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.

6.3 **National Stock Number Listing (NSN's).** The following is a list of nsn's assigned which correspond to this commercial item description. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the (CID).

7510-01-233-0033	7510-00-285-2966	7510-00-577-1086
7510-00-104-9315	7510-00-285-2967	7510-00-577-1162
7510-00-104-9316	7510-00-285-2969	7510-00-813-1221
7510-00-104-9317	7510-00-285-2980	7510-00-823-8074
7510-00-141-5553	7510-00-285-2997	7510-00-823-8075
7510-00-141-5556	7510-00-471-2889	7510-00-823-8150
7510-00-141-5560	7510-00-471-2890	7510-00-926-9146
7510-00-264-5987	7510-00-577-1007	7510-00-926-9147
7510-00-285-2965	7510-00-577-1082	7510-00-973-8297

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE:

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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